

Hrvoje Jerković, PhD

Data Architect | Principal Data Engineer

Šibenik, Croatia | Remote B2B | European working hours

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Online CV | LinkedIn

Profile

Data and solution architect combining hands-on engineering, technical leadership and education. Data and ML project experience since 2017, with a broader background in information systems. Specialises in lakehouse architecture, data lineage, reliable data pipelines and practical AI applications across industries, including automation, predictive analytics and data modernisation.

Core expertise

- **Architecture:** lakehouse/DWH, Medallion, relational and dimensional modelling; platform transformation, upgrades and modernisation, cost-efficient migrations, performance and cost optimisation.
- **Business and data consulting:** helping clients understand complex processes and turn fragmented data into useful analytics; identifying gaps in data, infrastructure and team capabilities; resolving pipeline problems and redesigning workflows to support informed decisions and business improvements.
- **Engineering:** Python, SQL, dbt, Spark, Delta Lake, Airflow, Kafka, Snowflake, PostgreSQL, Oracle, Elasticsearch and OpenSearch; batch, streaming, APIs and CDC patterns.
- **Cloud and delivery:** AWS, Google Cloud (GCP), Microsoft Azure, Databricks, DigitalOcean, Oracle Cloud, Docker, Git and CI/CD.
- **Analytics and digital marketing:** Google Analytics, Google Ads (AdWords), Google AdSense, Google Search Console (Webmaster Tools), Facebook/Meta marketing, cross-channel data integration, Tableau, Power BI and DAX.
- **Data governance:** Collibra, OpenMetadata, Unity Catalog, data cataloguing, metadata management, table/column lineage, data quality, access controls and auditability.
- **Delivery and applied AI:** prototypes and demos, implementation planning, technical coordination, testing and handover; RAG for document retrieval, local LLM evaluation, automation, predictive analytics and AI-assisted migration; mentoring and workshops.

Selected experience

Data Architect / Principal Data Engineer

Raiffeisenbank Austria d.d., Croatia (RBA) | Sep 2025 - Feb 2026 | Project case study

- Designed and implemented a banking lakehouse migration framework for an Oracle/PostgreSQL estate of approximately 4,300 ETL mappings and 1,800 landing tables. Defined Bronze/Silver/Gold layers and reusable dbt models targeting Spark and Delta Lake.
- Developed automated reverse engineering of ODI, DataStage and PL/SQL flows, reconstructing table- and column-level lineage across more than 20 source systems. Produced dependency graphs, SQL traceability and structured metadata for downstream automation.
- Built orchestration with nine specialised AI agents to translate legacy logic into dbt SQL. Ordered models by their dependencies, compiled and ran the SQL, compared results with production data and escalated failed checks.
- Removed the need for approximately 340 separately stored data-quality tables by running quality checks within the new processing flow. Handed over reusable models and pipelines to the delivery team.

Data Architect / Principal Data Engineer / Data Consultant

Intuita Consulting (UK group) | Sep 2022 - Feb 2024

- VIOOH / JCDecaux: digital out-of-home advertising analytics; led SQL/dbt upgrades in a Kafka/S3/Airflow/Snowflake pipeline handling approximately 1-5 million nested JSON records per hour. Investigated data issues using DataDog and Grafana.
- Designed and implemented a pipeline anomaly-detection and notification application using Python, SQL, AWS Athena, Lambda, Glue and Snowflake integrations.
- Altus Group: integrated Google Analytics, email campaigns, Salesforce, paid advertising and social-channel data into unified marketing analytics in Snowflake using dbt, Matillion and SQL.
- Built DataDQ advertising-data workflows with Airflow, S3 and Redshift. Implemented file ingestion, staging-table loads and updates for advertising viewability data.
- Comcast / Sky — metadata engineering: developed Python extraction and PostgreSQL models for Confluence documentation, structuring table, column, business and governance metadata for analysis and the wider Collibra environment.
- Comcast / Sky — GCP/AlloyDB prototype: built and tested schema-metadata capture using SQL and PL/pgSQL, with metadata refresh after DDL changes and audit records for table and column changes.
- Hyperoptic: mapped telecom data models to TM Forum SID/ODA using ER/UML modelling tools, connecting business processes, database entities and attributes with the industry information model.

Further architecture, AI and education experience — most recent first

Solution Architect / Technical Lead - eADR

Agency for Commercial Activities (AKD) / Croatian Ministry of the Sea, Transport and Infrastructure | Nov 2025 - Aug 2026

- Designed architecture and development specifications for six modules of an EU-funded national road-transport platform, connecting business processes, domain models, APIs, identity/RBAC, audit trails and reporting.
- Led technical coordination, stakeholder decisions, user acceptance testing and requirements-to-test traceability; specified API errors, retries and duplicate-prevention rules. Built a local RAG knowledge base for architecture and development specifications, combining semantic search, BM25 and MCP.

Data Engineering Instructor / Workshop Author

NEOS (KONČAR Group) | Apr 2026

- Designed and delivered a two-day Azure Databricks engineering workshop covering Delta Lake, Auto Loader, Structured Streaming, SQL, Unity Catalog, data quality and orchestration.
- Built banking demos, guided labs and assignments with dbt tests, Bundles and delivery workflows. Linked exercises to Associate/Professional certification topics and adapted them to the team's environment.

Lead Data Architect / Project Manager - Technical Bid and Demo

NEOS / Central Bank of Oman — pre-contract evaluation | Sep 2025 - Feb 2026

- Led on-premises lakehouse design, technical coordination and end-to-end requirements analysis, from real-time mobile-banking scenarios to big-data analytics. Prototyped data-lake exploration, regulatory submissions, validation-rule configuration, version comparisons and payment dashboards using simulated data; designed batch/streaming ingestion, governance and analytical access.
- Reached final-stage evaluation with the NEOS team and presented my work and project references to the bank's delegation in Zagreb.

Data Architect / Technical Lead - Road Transport Analytics

Agency for Commercial Activities (AKD) / Croatian Ministry of the Sea, Transport and Infrastructure | Jul - Dec 2024 | AKD Affinis

- Designed an open-source big-data lakehouse architecture and analytics platform sized for 250 TB+, 75,000+ drivers and 65,000+ vehicles. Defined 40+ safety, compliance and efficiency indicators integrating tachograph, inspection and ministry data.
- Prepared infrastructure, processing and other specifications in the full implementation documentation: Spark, MinIO, Trino, StarRocks, dbt, Dagster, OpenMetadata, PostgreSQL, Superset and Kubernetes.
- Led detailed task and specification development for data engineers, DevOps and analytics specialists; evaluated candidates and defined delivery responsibilities.

Data Architect / Head of AI

8tracks.com / mixer.fm | Apr - Aug 2024

- Big-data processing and analysis of audio files: developed AWS components with S3, Lambda, EFS, DynamoDB, PostgreSQL/RDS, SAM, CloudFormation and CodeBuild. Integrated pretrained models for genre, style, mood, instrumentation and danceability; built audio-feature extraction, metadata processing and an interactive waveform demo. Designed recommendation services with DynamoDB for user interactions and Redshift for analytical history. Evaluated Elasticsearch and OpenSearch for audio-feature and metadata search.

Data Engineer / Data Scientist / Lecturer

Algebra / Algebra LAB | Mar 2018 - Sep 2022

- IRI2 / Neural Grid: real-time grid regulation; developed software to compare phasor angles from PMU measurements, perform power-system calculations and trigger PLC actions. Used Python, Java and Kafka Streams; achieved a response below 50 ms, significantly faster than SCADA in this project.
- National labour-market analytics: served as Data Architect / Lead Data Engineer, migrated analytical processing to SQL Server and integrated employment and education data.
- Agricultural analytics: developed complex SQL views and Tableau dashboards for ministry-wide analysis of agricultural data.
- Erasmus ADSEE: developed computer-vision demonstrations and educational material using Python, OpenCV and Jupyter, connecting video preparation, detections and analytical tables.
- Course leader for Machine Learning on the Data Science master's, delivering part of its lectures and practical exercises; also taught Disruptive Technologies and E-business.

Earlier experience: Zagreb School of Economics and Management, 2002-2017 - information systems development and integration, technical leadership, digital learning and professional education.

Additional project work

- Vehicle-market analytics and price prediction: developed an XGBoost car-price model for Oglasnik.hr, with Tableau and Power BI analytics. Built an independent Airflow/PostgreSQL collection platform with new-ad detection and price-change tracking.
- Desktop property analytics: developed a Python/PyQt5 application for collecting, filtering and analysing property listings, with configurable notifications.
- News portal: built Python/PostgreSQL collection, Dagster jobs, AI summaries and article/category publishing; developed the project using Oracle Cloud.
- National register of regulated professions: designed the SQL Server database and developed a C#/ASP.NET Core application for profession records, qualification-recognition information, search, editing and audit.
- Occupational classifications: developed SQL Server and C#/ASP.NET Core software for maintaining Croatian occupational codes and their relationships with the Croatian Qualifications Framework, including search and change history.
- eFTI portal: developed Java/Spring Boot and React/TypeScript software for freight datasets, XML validation, subset selection, access links and audit.
- Independent websites and digital marketing: built and maintained websites, configured analytics and marketing tools, and taught these skills through practical student work.

Education and professional development

PhD in Applied Computer Science — University of Zagreb, Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing

Awarded 2012. Research: information-system interoperability and integration of learning platforms with digital repositories.

Udacity: Machine Learning Engineer Nanodegree; Deep Learning Nanodegree.

Credentials: SnowPro Core (2024); AWS Cloud Practitioner (2022).

Languages: English - full professional proficiency, including consulting and teaching; Croatian - native.